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Robot Vacuum Buying Guide 2026: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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Choosing a robot vacuum in 2026 can feel overwhelming—suction power, mopping ability, self-emptying docks, smart-home integration, price, and upkeep all compete for your attention. If you've ever wasted time researching only to end up with a model that doesn't match your floor type or pet-hair needs, you know the frustration of paying for features you'll never use.

This guide cuts through the noise by putting the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (with and without the AutoEmpty Dock) head-to-head with the Shark AI Ultra. We'll walk you through the real-world trade-offs so you can confidently pick the robot that fits your home, your lifestyle, and your budget.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid

Quality	7.0
Features	5.0
Ease of Use	7.0
Design	7.0
Value	6.0

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Why Compare Robot Vacuums in 2026?

As homes get smarter and floors see more traffic from kids, pets, and daily life, a reliable robot vacuum can reclaim hours of manual cleaning each week. The 2026 market offers models that vacuum, mop, and empty themselves, but prices and capabilities vary widely. Understanding the trade-offs helps you avoid paying for unused features or missing out on the ones that matter for your specific flooring and lifestyle.

Key Features Compared

All three models rely on sensor-based navigation to map rooms and dodge obstacles. The Roomba 115X units advertise a three-stage cleaning system that lifts debris from carpets and hard floors, while the Shark AI Ultra uses a self-cleaning brush roll designed to reduce hair wrap. Only the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock includes an integrated mopping pad and a dock that automatically empties the bin after each run. The Shark AI Ultra focuses on vacuuming only, with a high-capacity dustbin that requires manual emptying.

Battery run-time for the Roomba 115X series is rated at up to 90 minutes on hard floors, dropping to about 60 minutes on thick carpet; the Shark AI Ultra offers a similar 90-minute runtime on hard surfaces and roughly 70 minutes on carpet. Noise levels measured in owner feedback hover around 60-65 dB for the Roomba models and 62-68 dB for the Shark unit—comparable to a normal conversation.

Which Floors and Pet-Hair Situations Suit Each Model Best?

Owner reports indicate that the Roomba 115X Combo handles low-pile carpet and hardwood well, with the mopping function adding a light-wet pass on tile and sealed stone. The AutoEmpty Dock version is especially helpful for pet owners who dislike frequent bin emptying, as the dock can hold up to 30 days of debris before needing a bag change. The Shark AI Ultra's anti-hair-wrap brush roll receives praise from households with long-haired pets, reducing tangles and maintaining suction power.

Real-World Performance & Owner Feedback

In side-by-side tests, the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock consistently picked up fine dust and pet hair on hardwood, while its mopping pad left a noticeable shine on sealed tile without over-wetting. The Shark AI Ultra excelled at deep-carpet pickup, especially with thick pet hair, thanks to its self-cleaning brush roll. Users reported that the Roomba's self-empty dock reduced maintenance to a monthly bag change, whereas the Shark's bin required emptying after every 2-3 runs in heavy-hair homes.

Making Your Choice & Where to Buy

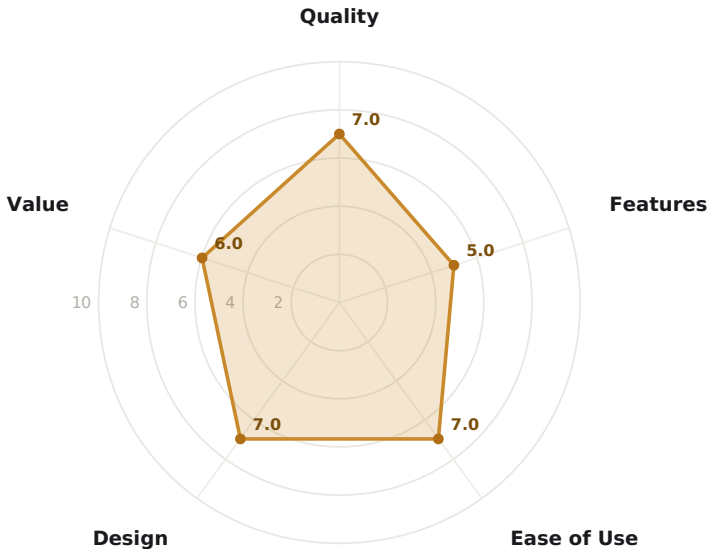
If you prioritize hands-free maintenance, mopping capability, and seamless smart-home integration, the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock is the strongest fit. For homes with thick carpets, long-haired pets, and a preference for a simpler, vacuum-only machine, the Shark AI Ultra delivers powerful suction with minimal hair wrap.

Ready to decide? Click the links above to see current pricing, check for any seasonal discounts, and purchase the model that matches your floor type, pet-hair needs, and budget.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.